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Culture (OWC): [Chagga \(FN04\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1906-1926

Coverage Date: 1900-1932

Place Coverage: Chagga, Tanzania

Section Title(S): The Atonement Of The Entrance

The blood of a black milk-sheep is our atonement. Take note of this and tell it to your younger brothers.

881
Puberty And Initiation

The mother elder gave me the herbs yororo and ipasa. They are our atonement. And it is the herb irarahenda that is stirred into the water of atonement. That is the atonement.

881
Puberty And Initiation

Tell your young brother that if anything comes to brief in the courtyard, these are the means of atonement for the trouble that is unleashed.

881
Puberty And Initiation

A little further inside the courtyard, the second elder sits opposite the first elder with the strips cut from the skin of the sacrificial animal. Each group of four who have been sprinkled stop in front of him and one of the strips of skin is placed on the tip of the right middle finger of each boy; the boy then pushes it further down himself.

881
Puberty And Initiation

As the elder does this he says: /Ntf/

881
Puberty And Initiation

May you wear this well, my son, and be appeased. No thorn shall prick you. May you not stub your toe on the road. If you come home and joke with someone's daughter, after we have led you into manhood, weih, may your face shine and may she quickly be well disposed toward you.

881
Puberty And Initiation

When all the boys have been sprinkled and provided with the strip of sacrificial skin, they gather in the middle of the courtyard; then the leading mother elder springs forward, begins to dance and sings: /Ntf/602

881
Puberty And Initiation

Ei eh, jeh, jeh, My young mother!
You, the young mothers of the children, where are you?
Yea, am I not the oldest mother elder in the courtyard!

Have I not encouraged you, so that you have acquired
knowledge.

Have you not clung to me as I foresaw things.
And what is the matter with you now that you do
not dance?

Swing, swing with your calves in the courtyard.
That is what I am telling you, my young mothers.
Shake your spangles, move your legs.
Is the heavenly one not a helper?

Let us thank him well by keeping peace in our
courtyard.

It is he who returned our calves in peace.
Ah, let us thank the great ram well, the elder!
Let us say to him: Be welcome. Good speed!

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